

Managing Knowledge (ISE542) - Year 26/27 Semester 1

Subject Guidelines

1. ADMINISTRATIVE INFORMATION

Subject Coordinator and Subject Lecturer:

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2. OVERVIEW

This is the first subject for the MSc Program in Knowledge Management (KM) that provides an in-depth overview of the KM field. It is a compulsory subject offered in a blended on-line and face-to-face teaching mode.

The subject is designed to provide participants with an overall understanding of what KM is, how it fits into and supports business operations, and how it is conducted. The subject introduces KM concepts, techniques and approaches which are supported by later subjects that create practitioner proficiency so participants can be effective KM practitioners. The purpose is to provide participants with an insight and introductory working knowledge to allow them to effectively apply KM in organizations to achieve their objectives.

3. LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

The aims of the subject are to:

1. Introduce the students the foundations of KM.
2. Provide the students with an insight and introductory working knowledge to allow them to effectively apply KM in organizations to achieve their objectives and lead and promulgate KM efforts for business effectiveness and success.
3. Equip the students with the practitioner understanding and proficiency to initiate, assess, operate, disseminate, and manage KM systems, projects, programs, and other KM efforts with an enterprise.

4. OUTLINE SYLLABUS

The subject aims to introduce the students to the foundations of KM. It is designed to provide the students with KM practitioner understanding of how KM fits into, and supports business operations with the further understanding of how KM is conducted from a system approach. Some of the key topics covered in this subject include:

Knowledge Management Essentials

Evolution of knowledge, theory and concepts of KM, Type of knowledge, nature of knowledge work

Managing Knowledge Processes

Various knowledge processes and their applications, methods and tools for managing knowledge processes

Knowledge Auditing

Role and importance of knowledge audit, knowledge audit process and practices, methods and tools for conducting knowledge auditing, analysis and reporting the results of a knowledge audit

Knowledge Management Related Strategies

KM strategy and how to manage culture aspects, and initiatives of KM, People-centric and IT-based KM from business perspectives based on understanding that business performance results from knowledgeable (competent), motivated, and accountable human actions, in part supported by IT capabilities.

Knowledge Management Practices

KM practices in different industries, the management of KM systems and projects, ethical issues in KM, case studies

5. STUDENT SUBJECT LEARNING OUTCOMES

Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to:

- a. understand the concepts and ethical issues in KM
- b. select and devise KM strategies, programmes and actions to provide effective business support
- c. conduct knowledge audit and use of various knowledge audit methods for analyzing and reporting findings for KM related planning
- d. To conduct a feasibility study on the implementation of knowledge management projects in an organisation.

6. METHODS OF ASSESSMENT

This is a continuous assessment subject. As shown in Table 1, the assessment is comprised of individual assignment, presentation, workshop assignment, personal learning environment and network (PLE&N), and open book test. All assessment components will require students to apply what they have learnt to realistic work applications.

Table 1 Assessment Methods and Criteria

Activities	Marking method	%	Submission
Personal Learning Environment and Network (PLE&N)	Each student is required to set up a Personal Learning Environment and Network (PLE&N) which is an on-line chat room. The students are required to contribute to their discussions and learning in this environment during the semester and beyond.	10	Assessment will be based on evidence of consistent and constructive contributions and discussions throughout the semester. The participants are expected to demonstrate consistent effort throughout the semester. Feedback will be given during the semester.
Individual Assignment	Each student is required to complete an Individual Assignment. The assignment questions aims to facilitate the students to reflect what they learn in classes and how to apply the theory in the real life examples.	20	On-line submission via Blackboard. Information on how to submit assignments will be provided in due course.
Workshop Assignment	Presentation: The performance of the participant's presentation in the KM Strategy workshop will be individually assessed.	10	The participants are required to make a presentation for their KM strategy.
	Written group report of KM strategy workshop	15	The participants are required to submit a group written report for KM strategy workshop.
Open Book Test	Three-hour open book test	45	The open book test will be held at the end of the semester.

7. STUDY PLAN AND TEACHING SCHEDULE

The subject will be delivered in face-to-face mode and the teaching is basically once per every week. Unless otherwise advised, lectures are conducted every Thursday from 6:30 pm to 9:30 pm. Table 2 shows the teaching plan for this subject.

Table 2 Teaching Plan

Semester Week No. (Day)	Activities	Staff	Venue
1 (3/9)	Subject Briefing Lesson 1: The Evolution of Knowledge - The evolution of the concept of knowledge - Defining knowledge - Differentiate various types of knowledge - To explain the way in which knowledge can be converted (Nonaka's cycle of knowledge conversion) - Meta-level of knowledge.	Benny Cheung & Eric Tsui Benny Cheung	V312
2 (10/9)	Lesson 2: What is Knowledge Management? - The concept of Knowledge Management - Nature of knowledge work and knowledge workers - Defining Knowledge Management - Reviewing how knowledge can be processed - To realize the multi-disciplinary nature of KM - To identify the common questions, success factors and benefits of Knowledge Management	Eric Tsui	V312
3 (17/9)	Lesson 3: Knowledge Processes (1): Knowledge Acquisition, Knowledge Generation and Innovation - What are knowledge processes? - Knowledge acquisition, knowledge generation and innovation processes and practices - Differentiate between innovation, knowledge acquisition and knowledge generation - Knowledge validation as a way to determine the quality of knowledge	Benny Cheung	V312
4 (24/9)	Lesson 4: Knowledge processes (2): Knowledge Transfer, Sharing and Retention - Familiar with knowledge transfer, sharing and retention - Knowledge transfer methods and how to support effective knowledge sharing - Develop culture for knowledge transfer - Various techniques for knowledge retention such as after-action review, etc.	Benny Cheung	V312
5 (2/10) Make-up class 6:30 pm – 9:30 pm	Lesson 5: Knowledge Management Systems and Tools - Role of IT in KM - Evolution of KM systems over the past 3 decades - Search engines and technologies - Value Creation by KMS - AI-enhanced KMS - Case Studies	Eric Tsui	Online
6 (8/10)	Lesson 6: Knowledge Management Related Strategies - Business strategy drives KM.	Benny Cheung	V312

	- Differentiate KM approaches to increase customer intimacy. - Methods in pursuing product and services leadership in KM. - Review existing KM implementation models Workshop: Part I – KM Strategy Briefing		
7 (15/10)	Lesson 7: Knowledge Auditing – Methods and Tools - The role and importance of a knowledge audit - The knowledge audit process. - The benefits of conducting a knowledge audit and the hurdles involved. - Various types of knowledge audit methods - Tools for carrying out a knowledge audit - KM related planning	Benny Cheung	V312
8 (22/10) 9:30 am – 12:30 pm	Lesson 8: Knowledge Auditing – Analysis and Reporting - Various methods for analyzing and reporting the findings of a knowledge audit such as Knowledge diagnostics, benefit analysis, knowledge network analysis, SWOT and social network analysis. - Use the findings of the knowledge audit findings for strategic planning. - How to implement KM initiatives and take action on the suggestions that result from a knowledge audit. - Alignment of the knowledge audit findings with business strategies. Workshop 2: Knowledge Auditing Tools and Practices	Benny Cheung	V312
9 (29/10)	Lesson 9: Managing Knowledge in Different Industries - Identify the driver for adopting KM in various industries. - Differentiate and explain various KM practices used in different industries.	Eric Tsui	V312
10 (5/11)	Lesson 10: Managing KM projects and applying KM to Project Management - Planning for a KM project - Challenges and Risks in KM projects - KM team compositions - Measuring success of KM projects - How KM can benefit Project Management? - AI-enhanced Project Management support	Eric Tsui	V312
11 (12/11)	Lesson 11: Managing and Culture and Taxonomy for KM Implementation - What an enterprise culture is? - The importance of culture aspects for KM. -Applying methods for fostering knowledge-supportive mentality and culture. - Derive incentive and culture drivers - Roles of Taxonomy and Its Applications in KM	Benny Cheung	V312

	- Method and tools for building and maintaining Taxonomy			
12 (19/11)	Workshop: Part II – KM Strategy Presentation (Session A) – V312	Workshop: Part II – KM Strategy Presentation (Session B) – V302	Benny Cheung and Eric Tsui	V312& V302
13 (26/11)	Open Book Test		Benny Cheung	V322

8. HOW TO ACCESS THE BLACKBOARD SYSTEM

This is a versatile and a popular platform, widely adopted by academic institutions worldwide for hosting online courses. The following are the instructions for using Blackboard:

1. Access <http://learn.polyu.edu.hk>
2. Log into the system using your NetID (Fig. 1).

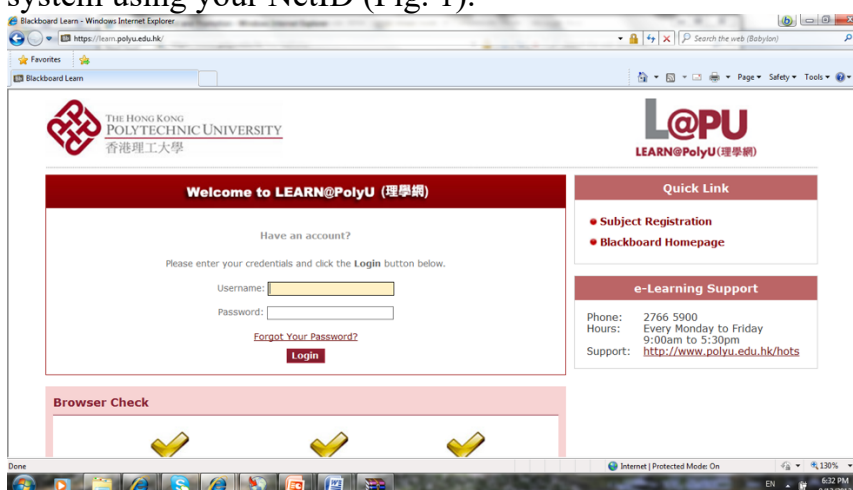


Fig. 1

3. Choose the desired subject. The homepage of that subject will appear (Fig. 2).
4. The Menu Bar contains links to My Places, Home, Help and Logout.
5. The *Navigation Bar* contains a *Show/Hide Navigation* toggle (allowing you to hide it to expand the *Content Area*), and a *Course Menu* section
6. The functions for teaching and learning include:
 - Content Materials
 - Bulletin Boards
 - Mail
 - Chat
 - Calendar
 - Feedback
 - Download
 - Assignment
 - Messages

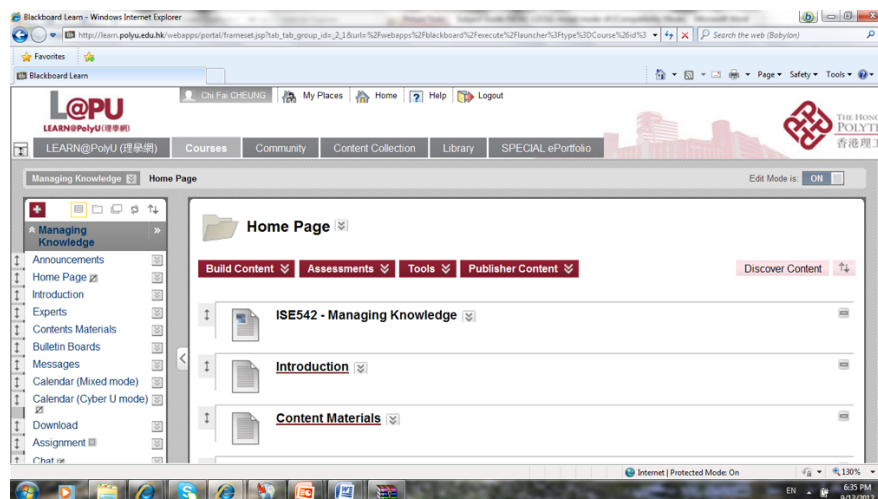


Fig. 2

Pedagogical Features

In order to help participants locate and interpret information easily, the following features are used. Please read through this section before starting your study.

Introduction: This provides the background information. Participants may find details such as learning objectives, pedagogical features, conventions, etc. in this section.

Experts: This includes bibliographies of the course developer(s). The Subject coordinator's contact information can also be found here.

Content Materials: These consist of interactive subject content which includes graphics, diagrams, animations, simulations, games, quizzes, videos, and audios. These materials are well supported by *Conventions* (Please refer to Table 4 for details), and participants are encouraged to make use of these online course materials for self-learning.

Download: These include documents in Adobe Acrobat (.pdf) format. The content is equivalent to the online materials. The difference between online and downloadable versions is that there are no interactive graphics and check points in the downloadable version. In case participants are not familiar with the online version, they may choose to download the materials and read them offline at their convenience.

Special Features of on-line Subject Materials

Conventions

For convenience of participants, a list of conventions is provided (See Table 3). Participants can save time when they understand how to use these.

Table 3 List of Conventions

An indicator of a participant's progress.	YOUR PROGRESS
A story. Optional further information is available.	STORY The telling of a story
A case example and it is usually followed by a peer-to-peer discussion or a tutorial exercise.	CASE A Case Study
A game that you can play with and learning from it. Click the link and try it out.	GAME A game learning environment
A concept that encourages deep understanding. You are encouraged to share your thoughts with other participants on the bulletin board.	THINK Thoughtful challenges
An animated figure (Macromedia Flash Player is required to view/interact with the figure). Click it and enjoy it.	INTERACT Animated Figure
Check Point A check point to self-assess your understanding of a particular section. This usually appears in <i>multiple choice</i> and <i>true or false</i> formats.	CHECK Self-assessment
When you see this icon, suggested reading is provided. It is suggested that you read a chapter of your text book, or read a magazine/journal article.	READ Further reading
This represents the time for peer-to-peer discussion. It is suggested that you discuss the topic on the bulletin board; your group facilitator will share his/her insights with you.	P-TO-P Go to bulletin board
Comic is a relaxed presentation of a topic. You may find the same situation happens in your daily life.	COMIC Take a look and learn more
The subject leader had prepared an exercise for you.	EXERCISE Enhance your understand
When you see this icon, please provide your opinion as feedback to the subject leader and the facilitators on the bulletin board.	FEEDBACK Go to bulletin board

SUGGESTED REFERENCES

Recommended Reading

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In Addition:

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23. Quba Ahmed, Muhammad Saleem Sumbal, Naseer Akhter, Hussain Tariq (2021) "Abusive Supervision and the Knowledge Worker Productivity: The Mediating Role of Knowledge Management Processes", *Journal of Knowledge Management*, Vol. 25 No. 10, pp. 2506-2522, <https://doi.org/10.1108/JKM-08-2020-0632>
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